MINISTRY OF HOME AFFAIRS

INDIAN CYBER CRIME COORDINATION CENTRE (I4C) • NATIONAL CYBERCRIME REPORTING PORTAL

Document Ref	MHA/I4C/SOP/2024/MULE-09
Subject	Standard Operating Procedure: Layer-1 to Layer-6 Mule Tracing & 90-Day Sunset Protocol
Issued To	State Cyber Crime Coordination Cells (S4C), State Police Nodal Officers, Scheduled Commercial Banks
Status	Operational Standard Operating Procedure for National 1930 Portal Integration

1. Operational Framework for 1930 Helpline

The Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting and Management System (CFCFRMS / 1930 Portal) enables immediate golden-hour lien placement to arrest fraudulent fund velocity. However, automated tracking often triggers downstream freezes across legitimate commercial merchants who unknowingly accepted secondary or tertiary transfers (Layer 3 to Layer 6).

2. Layer Categorization & Distinctions

• Layer 1 (Direct Beneficiary): Account receiving direct transfer from complainant's account. Subject to full debit freeze.
• Layer 2 (Immediate Distributor): First withdrawal or pass-through account. Subject to lien on disputed amount.
• Layer 3 to Layer 6 (Downstream Commercial Intermediaries): Merchants, vendors, P2P counterparties. Subject only to specific transaction lien.

3. Ninety-Day Sunset Clause for Downstream Accounts

If the investigating police unit fails to register an FIR and produce a Section 102 CrPC Magistrate report within **90 (ninety) days** of the automated NCRP lien on Layer-3 through Layer-6 accounts, nodal banking officers are instructed to automatically release the lien marking upon receiving written confirmation from the account holder.

LexSentry Legal Intelligence Registry • Authoritative Document Repository • Verification Copy